



Solution Guide: Creating Users and Setting Password Policies

In this activity, you used `net` to create two different kinds of users: a regular `user` and a `localgroup` Administrator user, and set new password policies.

-
1. Create a regular user, `Bob`, and set the user's password to `Ilovesales123!`:
 2. Run `net user Bob Ilovesales123! /add`.
 - `net user Bob *` will also let you change the password of an existing user (if you added the user without setting the password).
 3. Create a user, `Andrew` with the password `Ilovedevelopment123!`:
 4. Run `net user Andrew Ilovedevelopment123! /add`.
 5. Running `net user Andrew *` will also let you change the password of an existing user (if you added the user without setting the password).
- Add Andrew to the `Administrators` group:
 - Run `net localgroup administrators Andrew /add`.
 - Verify that Andrew is in the `Administrators` group:
 - Run `net user Andrew`.
 - 6. Launch `gpedit` and set the password policies for the entire Windows machine:
 - Run `gpedit` and under **Computer Configuration**, navigate to **Windows Settings > Security Settings > Account Policies > Password Policy**. Set the following:

- Set maximum password age to 90 days. While **Maximum password age** is highlighted, right-click it and click on **Properties** to see the tabs to enable and disable the option. You can also go to the **Explain** tab to see best practices for password expiration policies.
- Set minimum password length to 12 characters.
- Double-click on **Password must meet complexity requirements**, and set to **Enabled**. Select **Apply**, then click the **Explain** tab to read the following:

Unset

- Password must meet complexity requirements.
-
- This security setting determines whether passwords must meet complexity requirements.
-
- If this policy is enabled, passwords must meet the following minimum requirements:
-
- Not contain the user's account name or parts of the user's full name that exceed two consecutive characters
- Be at least 12 characters in length
- Contain characters from three of the following four categories:
- English uppercase characters (A through Z)
- English lowercase characters (a through z)
- Base 10 digits (0 through 9)
- Non-alphabetic characters (e.g., !, \$, #, %)
- Complexity requirements are enforced when passwords are changed or created.